KAL 421

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Kalmcs, and cholerie temperament, they live more amicably to-gether than one could expect in a people that led to independent life. They felaina come to blows even over their cups, and their quarrels are hardly ever bloody. A murder very rarely happens, though their anger has finding in it exceeding forces. It would feem that the morality of their religion, though ex-ceedingly delaltance, has been able to moderate their natural difjedition in the effect; it for in confignence of their dogmas, with regard to the transmigration of fouls, every reason murder either of men or beats is thought a deadly fin.

The Kalmus are exceedingly affable; and of fo-cali a algorithm, that its rare face a traveller or pe-ceive another, even at the difference of federal rules, without going to falute him, and to injure into the object of his memory. When I troup of Kulinar preserve my perform at a dilanze, it is customary for them to detach one of their number to the next emi-mones, from whence the idea a great with his cap for the perfor to the man. If this signal is not obeyed, the perfon is considered as an enemy or a robber, and is often purified as facts. They enter willingly into friendships; but these conclusions are not quite the timeted; for to give and to receive prendents are with them offential articles. A more trifle, however, istif-ficient to induce them to do you all manner of ferries; and they are never ungrateful as far as they are able. Adverify cannot deprive them to courage nor alter their good humor. A Kulinar will never beg if he were in the extreme miliers, but rather endeavor to support a faithleness by beating; and when no other way remains, he will fear himself to force rich individual of his nation, or to form Rullas, ciber as a herdifnn, a fisherman, or for any other first of la-bour. Very few of the rich value themselves much upon their wealth; but those who do, flow on con-tempt for the poor of their own nations, though the meaner fortely their court, very inforiously to the rich, who are always surrounded with a warm of idle dependents.

Nothing can be more prudent than that exercife of hospitality pretplied by understanding: is it so the greatest advantage to those among them who travel heroés their defers; and each individual who protatles it, may rely only keeping the bundle of it wherever he goes. A Kulinar provided with a hard, with arms and equipage, may enable from one place to anchor for three months together, without taking with him either money or problems. Wherever he comes he finds either dibant relations or friends, to whom he is attacked by the ties of holopitality, from whom he meets with the kindled receipation, and is concerned in the belt manner their circumstances afford. Perhaps he lodges in the full discovery costge he ends upon his road; and hence has be entered it, but his wants are fuppled with the molt affectionate cordiality. Every frunger, of whichever nature, never fails to be well received by a Kalmus; and he may depend upon ha-ving his effects in the greatest faculty the moment he has put himself under the protection of his holl; for to rob a quilt soundbordered by the Kalmus as the molt abonnable of all crimes.

When the matter of the hoofe fits down to meat in company with others of inferior rank, he begins in-

deed by feriving himself and his family, but whatever romans is difficult among the affiliates. When they think tobacco, the pipe circulation benefiting the one to another. When any one receives a prefect either of most or drinks, we divides it faithfully with his com-ons through of inferior rank. But they are much more

niggardly of their other effects, and efpeci- ally of their cattle, and did not willingly see these ways except when they hope to receive a flatbole re- turn : or if any relation has accidentally fuffered the old of his flocks, he is free to the molt willingly afflicted. Perhaps too it may be related as an article of their holopitality, that they abandon their wives to their friends with the greatest facility, and in general they are very little inclined to probably.

Their robberies are never committed upon their equality, and even the greater part of the engine ex-celd on other other is intended, on hand or national quarrels; neither do they willingly attempt this by open faces, but prefer the machinations of coming, which are on material to them. It must also be con-feted, that it is only those that live with princes, and its camps where their hold their courts, or the parents, that are now addicted to their preferences, while the common people, fatised with the pleafures of the paf-toral life, found their days in immense displirations, and water attacks the property of another till forced by sec-certify, or led by their fuuperiors who flown them the ex-amples.

The Kalmus are very faithful to their lawful prines they endure every fort of opreffion, and yet are with difficulty induced to revolts, but if they belong to a prince who has not become to by right of discipline, they very easily rebel. They honour old age. When young men travel with flash a are older than them-tives take upon then the whole race of the cat- tile as well as of the leaf. They are exceedingly prudent in matters that relate to their foreign or their nation, or which are recommended to their direction by the priests, to whom they yield an unreferved obe-diesers.

The moveable habitations of the Kalmus are thoef felt huts with a conical roof in the among all the roaming Alates. The trend ingousin attention of thefe tents was undoubtedly conceived in the eastern parts of Afis, and molt probably by the Mongol na-tions. As they can be entirely blackout to pieces and folded in a small compals, they are very useful, and perfectly served with the migratory life of their people, who are still ignorant of the use of earrings. The frame of thefe huts, and the felt they are covered with, though made as light to paddle, yet are a fluffed food for a stand or two war. But the capacity of these huts, their warmth in winter, their strength in riffing rempels and excluding rain, abundantly com-peride for this inconvenience. The wood defines many years; and though the felt begins to break into holes in the found year, the common people, who do not consider in the different to have them wonderland and patched, make them ferve a good deal longer. The huts are in general for from the prime down to the present Kalmus, differing only in fine and in the en-bellithments within. In winter, they are warm even when heated with the dried excrucments of their cats, to which they are often obliged to have recounts for

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Kalmucs. and choleric temperament, they live more amicably together than one could expect in a people that lead ſo independent a life. They ſeldom come to blows even over their cups, and their quarrels are hardly ever bloody. A murder very rarely happens, though their anger has ſomething in it exceedingly fierce. It would ſeem that the morality of their religion, though exceedingly idolatrous, has been able to moderate their natural diſpoſition in this reſpect; for in conſequence of their dogmas, with regard to the tranſmigration of ſouls, every wanton murder either of men or beaſts is thought a deadly ſin.

The Kalmucs are exceedingly affable; and of ſo ſocial a diſpoſition, that it is rare for a traveller to perceive another, even at the diſtance of ſeveral miles, without going to ſalute him, and to inquire into the object of his journey. When a troop of Kalmucs perceive any perſon at a diſtance, it is cuſtomary for them to detach one of their number to the next eminence, from whence he makes a ſignal with his cap for the perſon to draw near. If this ſignal is not obeyed, the perſon is conſidered as an enemy or a robber, and is often purſued as ſuch. They enter willingly into friendſhips: but theſe connexions are not quite diſintereſted; for to give and to receive preſents are with them eſſential articles. A mere trifle, however, is ſufficient to induce them to do you all manner of ſervice; and they are never ungrateful as far as they are able. Adverſity cannot deprive them of courage nor alter their good humour. A Kalmuc will never beg if he were in the extremeſt miſery, but rather endeavour to acquire a ſubſiſtence by cheating: and when no other way remains, he will hire himſelf to ſome rich individual of his nation, or to ſome Ruſſian, either as a herdſman, a fiſherman, or for any other ſort of labour. Very few of the rich value themſelves much upon their wealth: but thoſe who do, ſhow no contempt for the poor of their own nation; though the meaner ſort pay their court very obſequiouſly to the rich, who are always ſurrounded with a ſwarm of idle dependants.

Nothing can be more prudent than that exerciſe of hoſpitality practiſed by wandering nations: it is of the greateſt advantage to thoſe among them who travel acroſs their deſerts; and each individual who practiſes it, may rely on reaping the benefit of it wherever he goes. A Kalmuc provided with a horſe, with arms and equipage, may ramble from one place to another for three months together, without taking with him either money or proviſions. Wherever he comes he finds either diſtant relations or friends, to whom he is attached by the ties of hoſpitality, from whom he meets with the kindeſt reception, and is entertained in the beſt manner their circumſtances afford. Perhaps he lodges in the firſt unknown cottage he finds upon his road; and ſcarce has he entered it, but his wants are ſupplied with the moſt affectionate cordiality. Every ſtranger, of whatſoever nation, never fails to be well received by a Kalmuc; and he may depend upon having his effects in the greateſt ſecurity the moment he has put himſelf under the protection of his hoſt: for to rob a gueſt is conſidered by the Kalmucs as the moſt abominable of all crimes.

When the maſter of the houſe ſits down to meat in company with others of inferior rank, he begins indeed by ſerving himſelf and his family, but whatever Kalmucs. remains is diſtributed among the aſſiſtants. When they ſmoke tobacco, the pipe circulates inceſſantly from one to another. When any one receives a preſent either of meat or drink, he divides it faithfully with his companions, even though of inferior rank. But they are much more niggardly of their other effects, and eſpecially of their cattle, and do not willingly give theſe away except when they hope to receive a ſuitable return: or if any relation has accidentally ſuffered the loſs of his flocks, he is ſure to be moſt willingly aſſiſted. Perhaps too it may be related as an article of their hoſpitality, that they abandon their wives to their friends with the greateſt facility, and in general they are very little inclined to jealouſy.

Their robberies are never committed upon their equals, and even the greater part of the rapine exerciſed on other tribes is founded on hatred or national quarrels; neither do they willingly attempt this by open force, but prefer the machinations of cunning, which are ſo natural to them. It muſt alſo be confeſſed, that it is only thoſe that live with princes, and in camps where theſe hold their courts, or their prieſts, that are moſt addicted to theſe practices; while the common people, ſatisfied with the pleaſures of the paſtoral life, ſpend their days in innocent ſimplicity, and never attack the property of another till forced by neceſſity, or led by their ſuperiors who ſhow them the example.

The Kalmucs are very faithful to their lawful prince; they endure every ſort of oppreſſion, and yet are with difficulty induced to revolt; but if they belong to a prince who has not become ſo by right of ſucceſſion, they very eaſily rebel. They honour old age. When young men travel with ſuch as are older than themſelves they take upon them the whole care of the cattle as well as of the feaſt. They are exceedingly prudent in matters that relate to their ſovereign or their nation, or which are recommended to their direction by the prieſts, to whom they yield an unreſerved obedience.

The moveable habitations of the Kalmucs are thoſe felt huts with a conical roof in uſe among all the roaming Aſiatics. The truly ingenious invention of theſe tents was undoubtedly conceived in the eaſtern parts of Aſia, and moſt probably by the Mongul nations. As they can be entirely taken to pieces and folded in a ſmall compaſs, they are very uſeful, and perfectly agree with the migratory life of theſe people, who are ſtill ignorant of the uſe of carriages. The frame of theſe huts, and the felt they are covered with, though made as light as poſſible, yet are a ſufficient load for a camel or two oxen. But the capacity of theſe huts, their warmth in winter, their ſtrength in reſiſting tempeſts and excluding rain, abundantly compenſate for this inconvenience. The wood endures many years; and though the felt begins to break into holes in the ſecond year, the common people, who do not conſider it as diſgraceful to have them mended and patched, make them ſerve a good deal longer. The huts are in general uſe from the prince down to the meaneſt Kalmuc, differing only in ſize and in the embelliſhments within. In winter, they are warm even when heated with the dried excrements of their cattle, to which they are often obliged to have recourſe, for want.

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Figure 1: *
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